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-cho was easy to get along with. I don't recall having a real argument or fight as we were growing up. He exhibited, calm, quiet behaviour and rarely raised his voice. He exhibited quiet behaviour and rarely raised his voice and basically he was cool headed. He was kind, helpful and considerate of others. He kept in touch with people and especially the older people. He visited Catholic mission on Cordova St to see several nuns who were <sup>his</sup> teacher in Greenwood Catholic school. When they retired to their head convent in N.Y. he wrote letter to keep in touch.

Of the siblings, Ichio and myself were closest as we shared the common experience growing up in Greenwood. I will dearly miss talking to him on the phone.

I tried to be chronological as much as possible. The uprooting from the comfort of the coast certainly changed our lives. We worked hard to reestablish our lives.

I think father expected more from Ichio because he was the eldest. Anyway, I believe we developed a very strong work ethic.

Childhood goes back some 70 yrs. but  
I tried to put together some reflection,  
of Ichio's experiences which I believe is  
similar to mine because we started school  
together.

1940 Grade 1 in Prince Rupert

1941 Grade 2 Strathcona Elementary, Vancouver  
Japanese Language School after  
School. To this day it is in use  
and it is the only legacy of  
Japan town. It is designated  
as a historic site

Dec. 1941 Pearl Harbour, start of WWII

1942 Grade 3-8 Sacred Heart Catholic  
School, Greenwood (Private)

Grade 9-12 Greenwood High School  
(public)

With few belongings we arrived in an  
abandoned ghost town in the spring of 1942.  
School was not available for about 3 months  
before a makeshift school was set up by  
the Franciscan Catholic Missionary nuns.  
One floor of an old dilapidated firehall  
was hastily converted into four classrooms.  
we were on a 4 hr. shift, either in  
the morning or the afternoon.  
number of courses were limited to basics  
and catholicism was one of the subject.

We did not have the amenities of a public school so there was no gym, library etc. Consequently there was no extra curricular activities nor community recreation. It was a routine to attend church mass on Sundays. Christmas season was the most pleasant time. The concerts, carol singing, attending special midnight mass, going into the snow deep mountain to hunt and cut the "best shaped" Christmas tree was fun. Labour Day was another special day. Number of decorated floats lead by a pipe band paraded down the main street. Refreshments, food and games were offered for enjoyment.

In the early elementary grade years, I think we were like most kids, except that father gave us incidental chores like watering garden, feeding chicken but much of the time we did our own things. As we got a bit older in our elementary age we became more organized in our activities. We had variety of games which we had special names such as "kick the can", "piggy", hide and seek, shooting round marbles to remove the opponent's marble out of the circle drawn on the ground. In the winter we slid down the hill on a homemade sleigh and ski. Shooting puck at a goalie and road hockey was a popular pastime.

As we got a bit older, perhaps 12-13 yrs we were now able to construct and fly kites, make whistles, sling shots, stunts etc. We caught tadpole, dragon fly, trapped chipmunks, fished in creek etc. In the long summer evenings we frequently played softball with neighbourhood kids. We

Ichio was a good skater. He was taller than the average kid of his age and was able to join the school hockey team as a defence. I remember travelling to Kamloops for a tournament. As for school homework, I don't recall doing much except before test. As we moved into the senior years, we studied for major exams and in preparing for government exams in Gr. 11 and 12. Our public high school did not have a gym, library or science labs. I think Ichio's favourite (?) subject was geography/history. When we completed Gr. 8, that summer Ichio and myself had a 2 months job in the Okanagan orchard near Kelowna. Having to work away for an extended period was a wonderful experience. By the time we were in Gr. 11 or 12 the summer job was at N.P. fish Cannery near Prince Rupert. Father found small jobs for Ichio like cleaning dog pen, farm work, office errand work. One time dad took him to a mine site but I don't know what he did. He also spent few days out to a job renovating a hotel at Rock Creek. He also had a job during the skating season. Each night the ice was scrapped and flooded with water.

It seems Ichio and myself were always preoccupied with one thing or whether at home or away. We were in Jr 8 or 9 when dad decided to build our new home. No new lumber was available so he decided to use old lumber. We got some from an old carousel perched on the side of a hill. Ichio and myself hauled each piece of lumber to the new site. We made countless trips. Seems the high school years were much busier. Our property was fairly large so we grew variety of vegetables and kept as many as 70 chickens, few ducks and turkey. Feeding chicken, collecting eggs, cleaning chicken coop, digging, planting, weeding and watering garden kept us occupied from spring through to autumn. In the fall we harvested potatoes, Carrots and winter cabbage and stored them in the root cell. Cutting and chopping piles of wood for the winter was a task. Over the years we kept 3 dogs - one was a mix of coyotes we were told, the other a collie and a cocker spaniard. Ichio was fond of dogs.

Ichio shared a bedroom with Patrick. I think he had interest in current events. He would go to his room and spend time reading Vancouver Sun newspaper, Time magazine, Newsweek. I think he had a good knowledge of the W.W. II in the Pacific and Europe. He read the Sports magazine and kept abreast with the American College football. His favourite team was the "Fighting Irish" of Notre Dame, in the major league baseball his team was the St. Louis Cardinals, and in the NHL he like the Toronto Maple Leaf. He kept a scrapbook of star players and collected cards and photo of the Toronto Maple Leaf players. During the detention period radio was prohibited though later on we were able to get one but it was useless because the reception in the mountain area was bad. Ichio also did some stamp collecting of countries of British colony.

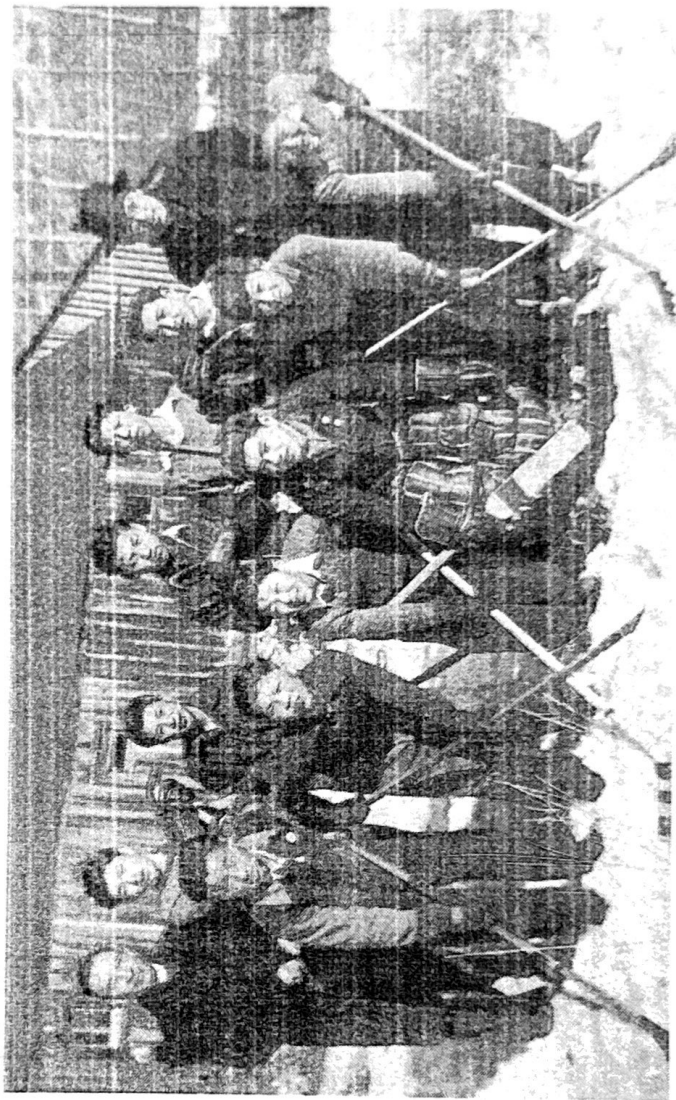
Now when I look back at those important formative years isolated in a detention camp, I wonder how much easier our lives could have been if we were not forced out of Vancouver and the coast. We were deprived of the many common amenities including school facility. In Vancouver the scope of awareness of opportunities would have been much wider and the path to a future career would have been totally different from what <sup>we</sup> ended up doing. I probably would not have chosen teaching.



GR. 8 PHOTO IN FRONT OF GREWOOD RINK

From the Nikkei National Museums Collections:

## Lost and Found



The Nikkei National Museum (NNM) in Burnaby, B.C. is requesting help to identify names, places, and other information or photographs they have in their collections. If you have further information on this photograph, please contact the NNM (email [Alexis.Jensen@nikkeiplace.org](mailto:Alexis.Jensen@nikkeiplace.org); or call 604-777-7000, ext. 140). When providing information for this photograph, please indicate the title: "A Portrait of the Sacred Heart Hockey Team; ~~Portrait~~ (?), B.C.", accession number (2011.83.1.83), and collection (Tasaka Family collection). You can also post what you know online at: [icnm-lostandfound.blogspot.com](http://icnm-lostandfound.blogspot.com)